

REMEMBER TERRITORY MAP

The Living Directory - "Who are my people and why do they matter?"

A synthesis of Ubuntu wisdom, lived experience, and design decisions

PART I: THE PROBLEM THIS TERRITORY SOLVES

The Pain (In the Integrator's Words)

"I have over the years accumulated strong networks and contacts but have done very little business with them. I ended up terming it 'social capital' - it is of use to others more than me. I even forget who I know and have a relationship with until someone asks if I know someone in that space."

The Five Symptoms:

1. **The Forgetting** - "Who do I know in fintech?" triggers a 5-step scavenger hunt (memory → phone → Gmail → ask friends → LinkedIn)
2. **The Exhaustion** - Simple requests become quests, leaving you depleted
3. **The Guilt** - You KNOW these people matter but can't access the depth when you need it
4. **The Superficiality** - Relationships feel reduced to "contact info" not "living connections"
5. **The Baobab Complex** - Your network serves everyone else more than you (giving shade but never eating your own fruit)

What Traditional CRMs Get Wrong

They optimize for:

- Sales pipelines (transactional)
- Lead conversion (extractive)
- Activity metrics (quantitative)
- Individual productivity (atomized)

But integrators need:

- Relationship depth (relational)
 - Mutual benefit (reciprocal)
 - Trust quality (qualitative)
 - Collective activation (networked)
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PART II: THE UBUNTU FOUNDATION

Core Philosophy: "Motho ke motho ka batho ba bang"

"A person is a person through other people"

What This Means for Design:

1. **Relationships Are Living** - Not frozen profiles but dynamic portraits
2. **Trust Is Currency** - Depth matters more than quantity
3. **Reciprocity Flows** - Who's turn is it? Not who owes whom?
4. **Resonance Varies** - Different frequencies are natural (active/warm/dormant)
5. **Memory Preserves Dignity** - Forgetting isn't failure, it's human

Research Groundings

Stokvel Practices (South African rotating credit):

- Transparent obligation tracking without shame
- "Whose turn to receive" language (neutral, not judgmental)
- Time flexibility (missing a cycle isn't moral failure)

Griot Traditions (West African oral historians):

- People remembered as "living stories" not "fixed attributes"
- Current journey matters more than past achievements
- Character essence over demographic data

Ubuntu Gift Economy:

- Reciprocity tracked as relationship state, not debt ledger
- Community holds collective memory
- Time allows fulfillment (no artificial urgency)

Elder Accountability:

- Reminders preserve dignity ("Ready to...?" not "You should...")
 - Assume good faith
 - Invite right action, don't command it
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PART III: THE USER EXPERIENCE

The Ideal Morning

Monday 9am: You open Pollinators

You see:

- Your **Active Circle** (12 people you're actively flowing with)
- Each person shows:
 - **What animates them** (current pursuit)
 - **Where you left off** (last conversation context)
 - **Who's turn it is** (reciprocity indicator)
- You feel: **Pride, belonging, clarity** ("These are MY people")

You can:

- Scan at a glance who needs your attention
- Choose when to act (transparent agency, not pressure)
- Search quickly if someone asks "do you know anyone in X?"
- Toggle to galaxy view if you want to see your constellation visually

The Three Core Flows

FLOW 1: Adding Someone New

Trigger: You meet someone aligned (a potential Pollinator)

Steps:

1. Click [+ Add Pollinator]
2. Enter basics:
 - Name
 - Organization
 - Role
3. Capture what matters:
 - **Current Pursuit:** What are they working on RIGHT NOW?
 - **Why They Matter:** One sentence on alignment/potential
 - **Tags:** Expertise areas (fintech, water tech, policy, etc.)
 - **Trust Level:** 1-5 stars + note on why
4. Choose tier:
 - Active (weekly rhythm)

- Warm (monthly rhythm)
- Dormant (low frequency but valuable)

5. Save

Result: They appear in your chosen tier, ready to activate

FLOW 2: Logging an Interaction

Trigger: You just spoke with Kgosi about the partnership

Steps:

1. Open Kgosi's profile
2. Click [Log Interaction]
3. Quick form:
 - **Type:** Call / Email / Meeting / Conference
 - **Date:** [Auto-fills today, editable]
 - **Summary:** One-line context ("Discussed partnership, I owe him feedback by Friday")
 - **Reciprocity:**
 - ☐ I owe them something
 - ☐ They owe me something
 - ☐ Balanced exchange
4. Save

Result:

- Last contact updates to "Just now"
 - Context snippet shows in his card
 - If "I owe them" → ● appears next to his name
 - Two weeks from now (if ● still there) → gentle nudge
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FLOW 3: Searching Your Network

Trigger: Someone asks "Do you know anyone in fintech?"

Quick Path (3 seconds):

1. Type "fintech" in search bar
2. See instant results (anyone tagged with fintech)
3. Pick the person, make intro

Deep Path (when you need precision):

1. Click [Advanced Search]
2. Set filters:
 - Sector: Fintech
 - Trust Level: 4+ stars
 - Tier: Active or Warm (skip dormant)
 - Last Contact: Within 3 months
3. Narrow results to 2-3 perfect matches
4. Choose based on who would MOST value the connection

Result: You find the right person in seconds, not hours

FLOW 4: Receiving a Gentle Nudge

Trigger: It's been 2 weeks since you spoke with Kgosi, and  "Your turn" is still showing

Experience:

- Notification appears (not intrusive, just visible)
- Message: "It's been 2 weeks since you spoke with Kgosi about the partnership. Ready to check in?"
- Options:
 - [Yes, Remind Me] → Opens draft space to send message
 - [Not Yet] → Snoozes for 1 week
 - [Mark Complete] → Removes the "Your turn" indicator

Tone: Elder asking, not manager demanding

Result: You act when ready, not when pressured

FLOW 5: Updating Someone's Journey

Trigger: You learn Malusi's XR pilot just got funded

Steps:

1. Open Malusi's profile
2. See: "Current Pursuit: Piloting XR training for mining safety"
3. Click [Update What He's Working On]
4. Edit text: "Secured funding for XR mining safety platform, now scaling to 3 sites"

5. Save

Result:

- Next time you see Malusi's card, you remember his NEW chapter
 - When someone asks about XR in mining, you think of him immediately
 - His portrait stays ALIVE
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FLOW 6: Toggling Views

Trigger: Friday afternoon, you want to reflect on your ecosystem

Steps:

1. Click [ Galaxy View] toggle (top right)
2. See visual constellation:
 - YOU in center
 - Active Circle in close orbit (brightest stars)
 - Warm Circle in middle orbit
 - Dormant Circle in outer orbit
3. Hover over any star → tooltip shows name + current pursuit
4. Click star → opens their profile

Feeling:

- Pride in your constellation
- Belonging to something bigger
- Inspiration to reconnect with dimmer stars

Toggle back to List View when you need to get work done

PART IV: THE ARCHITECTURE

Data Structure (What We Track)

For Each Pollinator:

Identity:

- Name (required)
- Organization (optional)
- Role (optional)

- Contact info (email, phone, LinkedIn)

Living Portrait:

- **Current Pursuit** (text field, manually updated via button)
- **Why They Matter** (one-line alignment note)
- **Tags** (expertise areas: fintech, AI, water tech, etc.)
- **Trust Level** (1-5 stars + text note explaining why)

Relationship State:

- **Tier** (Active / Warm / Dormant)
- **Last Contact** (date + context snippet)
- **Reciprocity** ( Your turn /  Their turn /  Balanced)

Interaction History:

- Log of past touchpoints (type, date, summary)
- Each interaction can mark reciprocity state

Metadata:

- Date added
 - Who added them (for team context)
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Visual Components

1. The Main Directory View (Default: Tiered List)

MY CONSTELLATION (150 Pollinators)

[🔍 Search: fintech, water tech, etc.]

[View: 📄 List | 🌌 Galaxy]

🔥 ACTIVE CIRCLE (12 people)

— Kgosi Kgomongwe — ● —

Scaling consulting business, securing
enterprise clients

Last: Discussed partnership - I owe feedback

Trust: ★★★★★ (Family + reliable)

Tags: Consulting, Government, Strategy

— Malusi Ramotshela — ● —

Secured funding for XR mining safety,
scaling to 3 sites

Last: Connected him with Thovhedzo - he owes
update on pilot results

Trust: ★★★★★ (Electrifying energy)

Tags: XR, Engineering, Mining, Innovation

[...10 more in active circle...]

💙 WARM CIRCLE (45 people) [▶ Click to expand]

🌙 DORMANT BUT VALUABLE (93 people) [▶ Click to expand]

2. Galaxy View (Toggle Option)



YOUR CONSTELLATION

YOU ● (you)

● Kgosi ● Malusi Active

● ● ● (inner orbit)

● ● ● ● Warm

● ● ● (middle orbit)

● ● ● ● Dormant

● ● ● ● (outer orbit)

[Hover over any star to see name + current pursuit]

[Click star to open full profile]

Color coding:

- Red glow = Your turn
- Blue glow = Their turn
- Green glow = Balanced
- Brightness = Trust level (5 stars = brightest)

3. Individual Profile View

Kgosi Kgomongwe

[Edit]



Trust: Family + reliable



Active Circle

CURRENT PURSUIT

Scaling consulting business, securing enterprise clients in government sector
[Update What He's Working On]

WHY THEY MATTER

My nephew. Implicitly trusted. We've built our bond on reliability and belief in each other over years.

RELATIONSHIP STATE

Your Turn

Last Contact: Oct 14, 2025 (2 weeks ago)

Context: "Discussed partnership on govt tender - I owe him feedback by Friday"

EXPERTISE & TAGS

Consulting | Government Relations | Strategy
Public Sector | Tenders

CONTACT INFO

Email: kgosi@example.com
Phone: +27 XX XXX XXXX
LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/kgosi

INTERACTION HISTORY

[+ Log New Interaction]



Call - Oct 14, 2025

- Discussed partnership, I owe him feedback
- Marked: I owe them



Email - Sep 28, 2025

- Sent govt tender opportunity
- Marked: Balanced

- 👥 Meeting - Sep 15, 2025
 - └ Coffee catch-up on family & business
 - └ Marked: Balanced

[View All 15 Interactions ▼]

4. Search Interface

Quick Search (Always Visible):

🔍 Search: fintech, water tech, mining... |

Type → Instant results below

Advanced Search (Click to Expand):

ADVANCED SEARCH |

Tags/Expertise: [fintech ▼] |

Trust Level: [4+ stars ▼] |

Tier: [Active, Warm ▼] |

Last Contact: [Within 3 months ▼] |

Reciprocity: [Any ▼] |

[Search] [Clear Filters] |

PART V: THE BOUNDARIES (What This Does NOT Do)

1. No Automated Anything

- ✗ We don't auto-import from LinkedIn
- ✗ We don't auto-update people's info
- ✗ We don't auto-send messages
- ✓ YOU control every addition, edit, and action

Why: Agency and intentionality > convenience and automation

2. No Relationship Scoring/Ranking

- ❌ We don't rank people by "value" or "strength"
- ❌ We don't give relationship health scores
- ❌ We don't predict "churn risk"
- ✅ We show tiers based on YOUR chosen rhythm

Why: People aren't pipeline metrics

3. No Social Media Integration

- ❌ We don't sync with LinkedIn/Facebook/Twitter
- ❌ We don't show social media activity
- ❌ We don't pull posts/updates
- ✅ We focus on YOUR direct relationship, not their public presence

Why: Privacy and focus > noise and distraction

4. No "Networking Gamification"

- ❌ No points for connections made
- ❌ No badges for introductions
- ❌ No streaks for staying in touch
- ✅ Intrinsic motivation (serving your people) > extrinsic rewards

Why: Ubuntu flows from care, not competition

5. No Algorithmic Suggestions (In This Territory)

- ❌ We don't auto-suggest "you should talk to X"
- ❌ We don't recommend connections within the directory
- ✅ That's REVEAL Territory's job (Hivemind)

Why: Each territory has its purpose. REMEMBER = recall. REVEAL = discover.

PART VI: UBUNTU ALIGNMENT CHECK

Principle 1: Collective Over Individual

- Tracks reciprocity (mutual benefit)
- "Your turn / Their turn" language (relational)
- Three circles of impact (Personal / Loved Ones / Collective)

Principle 2: Relationships Are Living

- Current Pursuit (dynamic)
- Interaction history (story over time)
- Manual updates (YOU keep them alive)

Principle 3: Trust Is Currency

- Trust level front and center
- Text explanation (not just number)
- Quality over quantity (curated list, not everyone you ever met)

Principle 4: Purpose-Filtered Vision

- Search by expertise aligns with YOUR current goal
- Tags help you activate network for specific needs
- Not just "who do I know" but "who can help with X"

Principle 5: Reciprocity & Memory

- Tracks what you owe, what they owe
- Remembers promises and follow-ups
- Gentle accountability without shame

Principle 6: Transparency Without Pressure

- Status visible at a glance (reality shown)
- YOU choose when to act (agency preserved)
- Nudges are invitations, not commands

Principle 7: Simplicity As Respect

- No feature bloat
- Every field serves daily use

- Clean, focused interface
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PART VII: WHERE IT COULD STILL GO WRONG

Risk 1: Update Fatigue

Danger: "Current Pursuit" fields become stale if user doesn't update

Mitigation:

- Button is LOW friction (one click, one field)
- No automated nagging to update
- Stale data is better than wrong data (people will update when it matters)
- Quarterly prompt: "Quick audit: Anything change with your Active Circle?"

Risk 2: Reciprocity Misuse

Danger: "I owe / They owe" turns into transactional scorekeeping

Mitigation:

- Language is neutral ("Your turn" not "You owe")
- No charts showing "debt balance"
- Emphasis on FLOW, not LEDGER
- Elder-voice prompts preserve dignity

Risk 3: Over-Categorization

Danger: Users add too many tags, directory becomes cluttered

Mitigation:

- Suggest 3-5 tags max per person
- Auto-complete from existing tags (consistency)
- Search works with partial matches
- Can always search by name if tags fail

Risk 4: Trust Score Reduction

Danger: 1-5 stars feels too simplistic for complex trust

Mitigation:

- REQUIRE text explanation alongside stars
- Stars are shorthand for search/sort

- Text is the REAL trust marker
- We can remove stars later if they feel wrong

Risk 5: Galaxy View Gimmick

Danger: Visual constellation is pretty but not useful

Mitigation:

- It's OPTIONAL (toggle, not default)
 - List view is primary (functional)
 - Galaxy view for reflection, not action
 - If no one uses it after 3 months, we can remove it
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PART VIII: SUCCESS METRICS (Ubuntu-Style)

What "Working" Looks Like

NOT:

- ❌ Number of contacts added
- ❌ Login frequency
- ❌ Search queries per week

BUT:

- ✅ "I haven't forgotten anyone important in 3 months"
- ✅ "When someone asks 'do you know...', I answer in 10 seconds"
- ✅ "I feel proud when I look at my Active Circle"
- ✅ "I've rekindled 2 dormant relationships this quarter"
- ✅ "The tool feels like a gift, not a chore"

Qualitative Indicators

After 1 Month:

- User has curated 20-30 key Pollinators
- Active Circle feels "right-sized" (not too many, not too few)
- At least 1 successful search ("found who I needed instantly")

After 3 Months:

- User has logged 10+ interactions

- User has acted on at least 1 gentle nudge
- User has updated "Current Pursuit" for 3-5 people
- User reports feeling "less exhausted" by network activation

After 6 Months:

- User has moved people between tiers naturally (life changes)
 - User has reactivated at least 1 dormant relationship
 - User describes the tool as "essential" or "liberating"
 - User has onboarded 1-2 team members
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PART IX: TECHNICAL CONSIDERATIONS (High-Level)

Data Storage

- Local-first (user owns their data)
- Cloud sync for backup/multi-device
- Encryption for contact info
- Export option (JSON, CSV)

Performance

- Instant search (even with 500+ contacts)
- Smooth tier expand/collapse
- Galaxy view renders without lag

Mobile Experience

- Responsive design (works on phone)
- Quick-add flow (3 taps to add someone)
- Swipe actions (log interaction, update pursuit)

Team Collaboration (Future)

- Shared directory for team
 - Permission levels (who can see what)
 - Activity log (who added/edited whom)
 - Note: This is LATER, not MVP
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PART X: NEXT STEPS (After This Territory)

Immediate (Build REMEMBER)

1. Create low-fidelity wireframes
2. Build basic data model
3. Prototype core flows (add person, log interaction, search)
4. Test with real data (your 20-30 Pollinators)
5. Iterate based on feel

After REMEMBER Is Solid

- Walk REVEAL Territory (Hivemind)
 - Walk RENEW Territory (Interaction Logging nuances)
 - Integrate all three territories
 - Team test with 2-3 real users
 - Refine, refine, refine
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CLOSING THOUGHTS

What Makes This Territory Ubuntu-Aligned

It's not a database of contacts.

It's a living memory of your tribe.

It doesn't track metrics.

It honors relationships.

It doesn't pressure you.

It empowers you.

It doesn't gamify connection.

It dignifies reciprocity.

It doesn't freeze people in time.

It celebrates their journeys.

This is REMEMBER Territory — where sleeping social capital WAKES UP.

Territory Mapped: November 2024

Status: Ready for Build (pending your approval)

Next: REVEAL Territory (The Hivemind)

"Motho ke motho ka batho ba bang"

A person is a person through other people